Md. Obaidullah

Department of Politics, University of Virginia
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Curriculum Vitae | November 2026

Education

2026-present PhD, Politics - University of Virginia

Fields: International Relations and Political Methodology

2024-2026 MA, Political Science - University of Southern Mississippi

Thesis: Diversionary Repression in Electoral Autocracies - Crisis Onset, Loss-Domain Conditions, and State Escalation. Committee: Joe Weinberg (chair), Marek Steedman, Maggie K. Martin

2020-2021 MSS, Public Administration - University of Barishal

Barishal, Bangladesh

2017-2020 BSS, Public Administration - University of Barishal

Monograph: Factors Shaping Citizens' Satisfaction with Local Governance - Evidence from Barishal Sadar. Advisor: Tasnuva Habib Zisan

Academic appointments

2024-2026 Teaching Assistant

Department of Political Science, University of Southern Mississippi

2024 Lecturer, full time

Department of Development Studies, Daffodil International University, Dhaka

Journal articles

Md. Obaidullah and Rakia Begum. 2026. “Regime Collapse without Civil War: Explaining Bangladesh’s July 2024 Uprising.” *Asian Journal of Comparative Politics*, OnlineFirst.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Machiavellian and Hobbesian Foundations of Democratic Decline in Bangladesh.” *Contemporary South Asia*, 34(3), 554-579.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Delivering Attraction? How BRI Implementation Shapes China’s Soft Power in Bangladesh and Pakistan.” *China Report*, 62(2), 257-277.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Choosing Not to Choose: Qatar’s Hedging in the U.S.-China Rivalry.” *Countries Studies*, 4(2), 335-371.

Md. Obaidullah and M. R. Howlader. 2025. “Assessing Geopolitical and Socio-economic Consequences of India-Bangladesh Water Disputes.” *Discover Global Society*, 3, Article 1.

M. S. Sohel, M. K. Sifullah, N. T. Zaman, B. Hossain, and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Beyond Borders: Mapping Out the Difficulties, Stress, and Coping Strategies in Transnational Irregular (Illegal) Labor Migration from Bangladesh.” *International Journal of Community Well-Being*, 8, 331-357.

M. K. Sifullah, M. S. Sohel, S. Jamil, B. Ahmad, M. A. Hossain, Md. Obaidullah, N. T. Zaman, O. Faruk, M. T. Islam, and N. Ali. 2025. “WASH Service Accessibility and Satisfaction among Street Informal Workers in Dhaka City: A Cross-Sectional Study.” *Discover Social Science and Health*, 5, Article 45.

Md. Obaidullah, M. Hossain, M. S. Raihan, and M. S. Hossen. 2024. “From Humanitarian Crisis to Burden: Understanding the Rohingya Refugee Crisis in Bangladesh.” *SN Social Sciences*, 4, Article 141.

M. S. Sohel, M. K. Sifullah, B. Hossain, M. F. H. Sarker, N. T. Zaman, and Md. Obaidullah. 2024. “Exploring Risky Health Behaviors and Vulnerability to Sexually Transmitted Diseases among Transnational Undocumented Labor Migrants from Bangladesh: A Qualitative Study.” *BMC Public Health*, 24, Article 1261.

M. M. Begum Mamy, Md. Obaidullah, N. T. Zaman, M. K. Saifullah, M. S. Sohel, M. Hossen, and G. A. Horaira. 2024. “Navigating Vulnerabilities: The Untold Story of Informal Households in Dhaka, Bangladesh during the COVID-19 Pandemic.” *New Zealand Journal of Asian Studies*, 26(2), 75-98.

M. S. Sohel, S. Alam, M. M. Rahman, Md. Obaidullah, A. A. S. M. Towhidul, M. B. Hossain, and M. A. Hossain. 2024. “Exploring the Multifaceted Vulnerabilities of Female Street Child Labor in the Capital City of Bangladesh.” *Heliyon*, 10(18), e37302.

M. S. Sohel, S. Jamil, Md. Obaidullah, B. Hossain, H. M. Ali, M. S. Hossen, M. S. Uddin, T. Ahsan, and N. F. Eva. 2024. “Healthcare Challenges in Disaster-Prone Riverine Islands: A Study of Sirajgonj, Bangladesh.” *International Journal of Community Well-Being*, 7, 491-515.

M. F. H. Sarker, S. F. Ahmed, U. Kawser, M. S. Hossen, Md. Obaidullah, S. Khan, M. K. Sifullah, and M. S. Sohel. 2024. “Is E-business Breaking Down Barriers for Bangladesh’s Young Female Entrepreneurs during the COVID-19 Pandemic? A Qualitative Study.” *SN Social Sciences*, 4, Article 107.

S. Jamil, Md. Obaidullah, and M. Alam. 2023. “Unusual Increase of Cesarean Section Delivery in Bangladesh: Correspondence.” *Annals of Medicine and Surgery*, 85(5), 2242.

Md. Obaidullah, S. Jamil, H. M. Ali, and A. Akhter. 2023. “Burning Up: How Heatwaves Pose a Threat to Public Health.” *IJS Short Reports*, 8(3).

Book chapters

Md. Obaidullah and M. Hossain. 2025. “China’s Soft Power Strategy in the Middle East and East Asia: A Comparative Analysis.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-22.

Md. Obaidullah and R. Begum. 2025. “The Rohingya Crisis and Its Effect on Bangladesh-Myanmar Bilateral Relations: A Historical Analysis.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-19.

M. S. Sohel, M. K. Sifullah, M. F. H. Sarker, M. A. Hossain, and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Security Questions Explained: Irregular Migrants to Europe.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-16.

Md. Obaidullah and M. Hossain. 2025. “Major Powers’ Approaches to the Rohingya Crisis and Their Impact on Bangladesh.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-30. Latest living-reference version.

M. Hossain and Md. Obaidullah. 2024. “China’s Diplomatic Approach to the Rohingya Crisis: Balancing Economic Interests and Humanitarian Concerns.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-24.

M. S. Sohel, M. A. Hossain, M. F. H. Sarker, M. K. Sifullah, Md. Obaidullah, and A. A. Ullah. 2024. “Bangladeshi Undocumented Migration Crisis in Europe: Implications of Security, Human Rights, and Policy.” *Handbook of Migration, International Relations and Security in Asia*, Edited by AKM Ahsan Ullah. Springer, pp. 1-18.

Md. Obaidullah and M. S. Raihan. 2024. “Soft Power Competition: A Comparative Analysis of China and the US in South Asia.” *Soft Power and Diplomatic Strategies in Asia and the Middle East*, Edited by M. Zreik. IGI Global, pp. 197-226.

Book reviews

M. Hossain and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Power of Bonding and Non-Western Soft Power Strategy in Iran: Comparing China and India’s Engagement.” *Contemporary South Asia*, 33(1), 145-146.

M. Hossain and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “We Had the Watches. They Had the Time: A Witness Account of the War in Afghanistan.” *Small Wars & Insurgencies*, 36(1), 241-243.

Md. Obaidullah and M. Hossain. 2024. “Rohingya Refugee Crisis in Myanmar: Ethnic Conflict and Resolution, eds. Bulbul, Islam, and Khan.” *Society and Culture in South Asia*, 10(1), 142-145.

Working papers

Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “India’s Influence on Authoritarianism in South Asia: The Case of Sheikh Hasina’s Bangladesh (2009-2024).” *Under review*.

Public writing

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “The Border Killing Fields Separating India and Bangladesh.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Invisible Diplomats.” *New Age*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “What If Iran’s Next Target Is the Gulf’s Water Supply?.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “China Quietly Eclipsing a Weakened Russia in Central Asia.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah and Z. Ahmed. 2026. “Bangladesh First: BNP’s Path to a Winning Foreign Policy.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Why the EU-India Trade Deal Could Be Bad News for Bangladesh.” *The Diplomat*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2026. “Why China and Russia Blinked as the United States Moved on Venezuela.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “CPEC’s Afghan Push Poses a New Challenge for India.” *East Asia Forum*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Turkey-Bangladesh Air Defense Deal Jolts South Asia’s Skies.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Rohingya Crisis Demands More Than Paper Promises.” *New Age*.

M. Hossain and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “India and Bangladesh in a Crucial Test of Trust over the Border.” *Asia Times*.

Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “India’s Opposition to Bangladesh’s Defense Modernization Is a Self-Defeating Strategy.” *The Diplomat*.

K. U. Mahmud and Md. Obaidullah. 2025. “Will Trump 2.0 End the Liberal International Order?.” *The Daily Star*.

Editorial and policy experience

2025-2026 Public Affairs and Consular Intern

Bangladesh High Commission to the Maldives, Malé (remote)

2024-2025 Commissioning Editor

E-International Relations, United Kingdom (remote)

2021 Policy Research Intern

Youth Policy Forum, Dhaka

Research experience

2022-2023 Research Assistant

BRAC James P Grant School of Public Health, Dhaka (remote)

2021-2022 Research Assistant

Centre for Advanced Research, Dhaka

Fellowships, awards, and funding

2026-2031 Doctoral Funding Package in Politics

University of Virginia - full tuition, fees, health insurance, and living support

2026 John L. Nau III Graduate Fellowship

University of Virginia - selective education and research fund

2024-2026 Graduate Teaching Assistantship in Political Science

University of Southern Mississippi - stipend with full and out-of-state tuition waivers

2024-2025 Outstanding Graduate Student in Political Science

University of Southern Mississippi

2018 CZM Genius Scholarship

Center for Zakat Management, Bangladesh

Conference presentations

2026 Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference

Chicago, Illinois

2025 Midwest Political Science Association Annual Conference

Chicago, Illinois

Methods training

2024 Data Analytics with R for Data Science

Statistical Research Consultants in Bangladesh, Dhaka

2021 Qualitative Data Analysis Using NVivo

Centre for Advanced Research, Dhaka

Leadership and community

2021-2022 Joint General Secretary

Bangladesh Youth Writers' Forum

2020-2022 Campus Ambassador

Youth Society for Research and Action

2019-2023 Vice President

National Human Rights Society Bangladesh, University of Barishal chapter

2019 Volunteer

International Conference on Social Sciences and Law, University of Barishal

Scholarly service

Peer reviewer: BMC Public Health; SN Social Sciences; International Journal of Community Well-Being; International Journal of Sociology and Social Policy; PLOS ONE; PLOS Global Public Health; International Journal of Water Resources Development; Southeast Asia: A Multidisciplinary Journal; Cogent Social Sciences.

Skills and languages

Languages: Bangla (native), English (fluent), Hindi (conversational), Arabic (basic)

Quantitative: R, RStudio, SPSS

Qualitative and survey: NVivo, Qualtrics

Writing and reference: LaTeX, BibTeX, Zotero, Mendeley